

Student-Based Resource Allocations

**A Memorandum of Understanding between the Board of Education and the
Boulder Valley Education Association**

Purpose

The purpose of this MOU is to establish the parameters of an ongoing work group charged with using professional judgment and research/experts to facilitate as needed, in order to determine appropriately differentiated student-based allocations of school resources in BVSD; to ensure that all schools have an equitable playing field, and make recommendations for the allocation of resources based on the diverse needs of students, classrooms, schools, and communities across BVSD. This work will support the BVSD Vision, Mission, Values Goals and the BVSD Strategic Plan.

Executive Summary

This MOU was developed during Consensus Based Bargaining in 2014. It results from a survey of hundreds of BVSD educators across the District who expressed strong interest in developing a weighted student allocation method that would effectively provide differentiated support to address the needs of all students and communities across BVSD.

[Student Based Resource Allocations MOU Final Report](#)

Summary of Committee Work

- Met for 36 hours from fall 2015 through fall 2016
- Created vision and mission statements
- Learned about school finance and BVSD funding formulas
- Conducted extensive research on differentiated school funding models
- Aligned information with the Success Effect
- Established funding priorities
- Created funding recommendations
- Attained consensus on funding recommendations

Recommendations

Further funding available beyond what is necessary to maintain current levels of services, including maintaining the current staffing ratios, shall be allocated:

1. Up to the first \$1.5 million will be divided among schools based on the number of students with a **Free and Reduced Lunch designation**.
2. Funds beyond the initial \$1.5 million and up to an additional \$1.5 million will be divided among schools based on the number of students with a **Special Education designation**.
3. Funds beyond the initial \$3 million and up to an additional \$1.5 million will be divided among schools based on the number of students with an **English Language Developing designation**.

Implementation Guidelines

- Resources are allocated to schools annually in the form of **Regular Ed Teacher FTE** based on the **prior year's October Count** data.
- Existing **parameters for FTE conversions apply** in the use of these additional funds.
- While this **child-centered funding model** is intended to support students in specific categories, the outcome of strategies implemented may, as a secondary effect, benefit the entire school population.
- **Use of additional resources will be determined through shared decision making** and aligned with the strategies developed collaboratively as part of the UIP, therefore **accountability measures** for use of these funds are **embedded within the UIP**.

Conclusion

Our vision is to create a culture where parents, teachers, staff, students, administrators, and community members will embrace all of BVSD as one community. The positive feelings people have for their school will extend to our district as a whole. We believe that all students should be allocated the appropriate resources to meet their diverse needs so that they can access the curriculum and learn through highly effective instruction. The overall goal is to further student success, with the intention of making them lifelong learners.